

WAP and the early failures have been masked, as the real point of the system—access to wireless services and applications—has come to the forefront. Spin-off technologies such as MMS, a combination of WAP and SMS, have further driven the protocol.

4.4.2 The Microbrowser

A microbrowser (sometimes minibrowser or mobile browser) is a Web browser designed for use on a handheld device such as a PDA or mobile phone. Microbrowsers are optimised so as to display Internet content most effectively for small screens on portable devices, and have small file sizes to accommodate the low memory capacity and low bandwidth of wireless handheld devices. Essentially, they are stripped-down Web browsers.

The microbrowser usually sets up the cellular networks themselves and gets content written in XHTML Mobile Profile (WAP 2.0), or WML (WAP 1.3 which was based on HDML). WML and HDML are stripped-down formats suitable for transmission across limited bandwidth, and wireless data connection called WAP. In Japan, DoCoMo defined the i-mode service based on i-mode HTML, which is an extension of Compact HTML (C-HTML), a simple subset of HTML.

WAP 2.0 specifies XHTML Mobile Profile plus WAP CSS, subsets of the W3C's standard XHTML and

